

Returns to Education in Canada: An Econometric Analysis of Real Wages, 2018–2025

1. Introduction

Education has long been recognized as one of the key determinants of earnings in labour economics. Human capital theory suggests that individuals acquire schooling in order to increase productivity, which is then rewarded through higher wages in competitive labour markets. The magnitude of these returns, however, varies across countries, labour market structures, occupations, industries, and time. Understanding the return to education in Canada is especially important given the country's rising postsecondary participation rates and the growing polarization of work.

This paper provides new empirical evidence on the relationship between educational attainment and real hourly wages in Canada, using pooled Labour Force Survey (LFS) microdata from 2018–2025. The objective is to estimate the wage premium associated with different education levels after controlling for a rich set of demographic, job, and regional characteristics. The analysis extends standard Mincer-style models by incorporating detailed controls for occupation, industry, union membership, establishment size, family structure, province, and year fixed effects.

The findings reveal a strong, monotonic, and economically large wage gradient across education levels. Even after controlling for extensive covariates, university and postgraduate degrees yield substantial wage premiums relative to workers with low education, while gender, occupation, and industry remain powerful predictors of wage variation. The results align with human capital theory and reflect ongoing skill-biased labour demand in the Canadian economy.

1.2 Literature Review

- Mincer (1974): In his seminal paper, Mincer derived a wage equation that related earnings to schooling years and labor market experience. His finding was that there was a positive percentage return in wages for each additional year of schooling, which has become the foundation of modern human capital research. While influential, the study focused on U.S. data and may not have accounted for the unique institutional and policy environment of Canada.

- Oreopoulos (2006): Taking advantage of Canadian mandatory school legislation as a natural experiment, Oreopoulos found that marginal increments in schooling significantly enhanced lifetime wages. Good evidence is provided by this study for positive causal effects of schooling on earnings but primarily for compulsory schooling rather than postsecondary levels and raises unanswered questions regarding overall returns.
- Lemieux (2014): Lemieux examined the changing wage structure in Canada and came to the conclusion that education remains a dominant determinant of compensation but interacts with gender, field of study, and location in a very strong manner. He observed growing divergence in returns and suggested that not all gain equally from additional schooling.

These studies confirm that education has the tendency to leave positive effects on earnings, but the amount and trend of returns vary. The gap in the literature is for fresh empirical evidence for recent Canadian data controlling for heterogeneity by industry/occupation, gender, and regions. That is the gap this paper intends to fill.

2. Data

2.1 Data Source and Sample

The analysis uses the LFS Public Use Microdata File (PUMF), pooled across the years 2018–2025. The LFS is Canada’s primary household labour market survey, covering detailed employment characteristics for individuals aged 15 and older. The estimation sample is restricted to:

- employed individuals,
- with valid hourly wages,
- aged 20 or older.

Survey weights are applied throughout. After restrictions, the estimation sample contains **1,759,743 observations**, representing approximately **558 million weighted person-records**.

2.2 Variables

The dependent variable is **ln_real_wage**, the natural logarithm of real hourly wage adjusted to September 2025 dollars. Real wage and hourly wage also appear in the summary statistics table for transparency.

The key independent variable is **education**, using the LFS's seven-category education classification:

1. 0–8 years (reference)
2. Some high school
3. High school graduate
4. Some postsecondary
5. Postsecondary certificate or diploma
6. Bachelor's degree
7. Above bachelor's degree

Control variables include demographic characteristics (gender, age, marital status, economic family type, youngest child age), labour market indicators (occupation, industry, union status, multiple jobholding, class of worker), job characteristics (establishment size, firm size), and geographic/time controls (CMA, province, year).

2.3 Summary Statistics

Table 1a.

```
. summarize ln_real_wage real_wage hourly_wage TENURE experience i.GENDER i.education i.union_member i.cma i.province [aw= weight ] if e(sample)==1, se
> parator(0)
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Variable	Obs	Weight	Mean	Std. dev.	Min	Max
ln_real_wage	1759743	558345526	8.206615	.4658849	5.948079	10.20865
real_wage	1759743	558345526	4096.716	2086.64	383.0167	27137
hourly_wage	1759743	558345526	3669.086	1908.262	321	27137
TENURE	1759743	558345526	101.0515	80.86626	1	240
experience	1759743	558345526	8.420956	6.738855	.0833333	20
GENDER						
Man	1759743	558345526	.481743	.4996667	0	1
Woman	1759743	558345526	.518257	.4996667	0	1
education						
0 to 8 ye..	1759743	558345526	.0074915	.0862284	0	1
Some high..	1759743	558345526	.0306713	.1724256	0	1
High scho..	1759743	558345526	.1289533	.3351484	0	1
Some post..	1759743	558345526	.0302651	.1713158	0	1
Postsecon..	1759743	558345526	.3856712	.4867536	0	1
Bachelor'..	1759743	558345526	.2740798	.4460495	0	1
Above bac..	1759743	558345526	.1428677	.349938	0	1
union_member						
Union mem..	1759743	558345526	.3347964	.4719194	0	1
Not a mem..	1759743	558345526	.02133	.144482	0	1
Non-union=d	1759743	558345526	.6438736	.4788533	0	1

cma						
Other CMA..	1759743	558345526	.443261	.4967704	0	1
Québec	1759743	558345526	.0253002	.1570353	0	1
Montréal	1759743	558345526	.1223261	.3276622	0	1
Ottawa-G..)	1759743	558345526	.0354649	.1849517	0	1
Toronto	1759743	558345526	.1699047	.3755492	0	1
Hamilton	1759743	558345526	.0223753	.1479009	0	1
Winnipeg	1759743	558345526	.0255671	.15784	0	1
Calgary	1759743	558345526	.0459409	.209357	0	1
Edmonton	1759743	558345526	.0429933	.2028421	0	1
Vancouver	1759743	558345526	.0668664	.2497905	0	1
province						
Newfoundl..	1759743	558345526	.013299	.1145521	0	1
Prince Ed..	1759743	558345526	.0041678	.0644241	0	1
Nova Scotia	1759743	558345526	.0236642	.1520008	0	1
New Bruns..	1759743	558345526	.020116	.140397	0	1
Quebec	1759743	558345526	.233404	.4229973	0	1
Ontario	1759743	558345526	.3922003	.4882411	0	1
Manitoba	1759743	558345526	.0370155	.1887998	0	1
Saskatchewn	1759743	558345526	.0309136	.1730837	0	1
Alberta	1759743	558345526	.1237997	.329353	0	1
British C..	1759743	558345526	.1214199	.3266147	0	1

Table 1b.

These statistics are weighted using $aw=[weight]$ and restricted to the estimation sample $e(sample)=1$. For categorical variables, means represent the proportion of individuals in each category. The tables show that:

- The average real hourly wage is roughly \$40 (in 2025 dollars).

- Education distribution reflects a heavily credentialed workforce, with more than one-third holding a postsecondary diploma.
- Women represent approximately 51% of the employed sample.
- Union membership is relatively low, with most workers non-unionized.
- Provinces are proportionally represented, with Ontario, Quebec, Alberta, and British Columbia comprising the majority of the weighted sample.
- CMA indicators show that 44% of workers reside outside major metropolitan areas.

These statistics provide the empirical starting point for understanding wage patterns before conditioning on covariates.

3. Descriptive Evidence

Before turning to regression analysis, it is informative to examine unconditional wage distributions across education groups.

Figure 1: Kernel Density of Log Real Wages (0–8 Years vs BA)

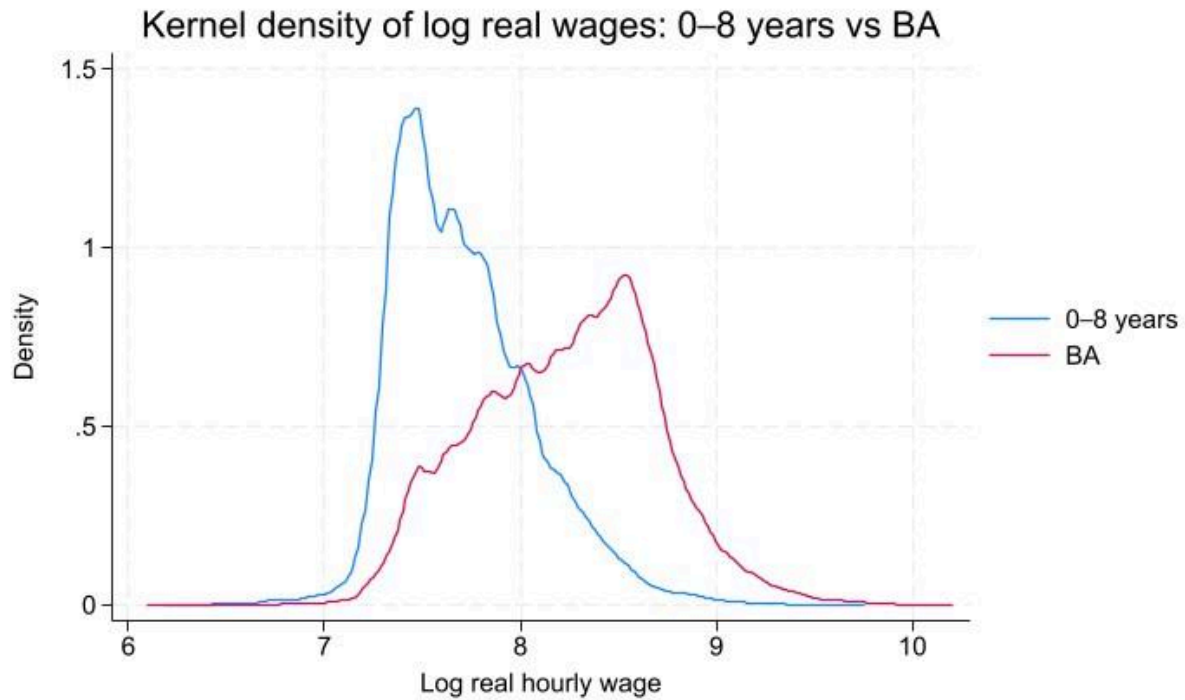


Figure 1 illustrates clear differences in the distribution of log real wages between individuals with very low schooling (0–8 years) and those with a bachelor’s degree. Workers with 0–8 years exhibit a compressed wage distribution centered at lower wage levels, with very limited upper-tail mass. In contrast, university graduates have a substantially higher median log wage and a noticeably thicker right tail, reflecting access to higher-paying occupations and industries. This visual evidence strongly suggests that education is associated with both higher average wages and greater wage dispersion.

4. Empirical Model

The main regression model is:

$$\ln(w_i) = \beta_1 Education_i + X_i' \gamma + \delta_p + \delta_t + \varepsilon_i,$$

where:

- $Education_i$ is the seven-category education variable (reference = 0–8 years),

- X_i contains demographic, job, and family characteristics,
- δ_p are province fixed effects,
- δ_t are year fixed effects,
- Standard errors are clustered at the province level.

This fully saturated model controls for major sources of wage heterogeneity, allowing the education coefficients to be interpreted as conditional wage differences.

5. Results

5.1 Education Returns

The regression results indicate strong and monotonic returns to education:

- Some high school: **+3.8%**
- High school graduate: **+6.7%**
- Some postsecondary: **+10.1%**
- Postsecondary diploma: **+14.1%**
- Bachelor's degree: **+26.8%**
- Above bachelor's degree: **+34.9%**

All estimates are significant at the 1% level. The premium increases sharply for higher education levels, especially at the bachelor's and postgraduate levels. This pattern supports the human capital framework: higher educational attainment is associated with substantial productivity advantages rewarded in the labour market.

5.2 Gender Wage Gap

Women earn **approximately 15.7% less** than men after controlling for education, occupation, industry, region, and job characteristics. This conditional gender gap is consistent with previous Canadian research and indicates persistent structural disparities.

5.3 Regional Variation

Province effects show:

- Wage advantages in Alberta (+12.4%), British Columbia (+11.1%), and Ontario (+6%).
- Wage penalties in Atlantic provinces (−5% to −7%).

Even with extensive controls, regional differences remain pronounced.

5.4 Occupation Effects

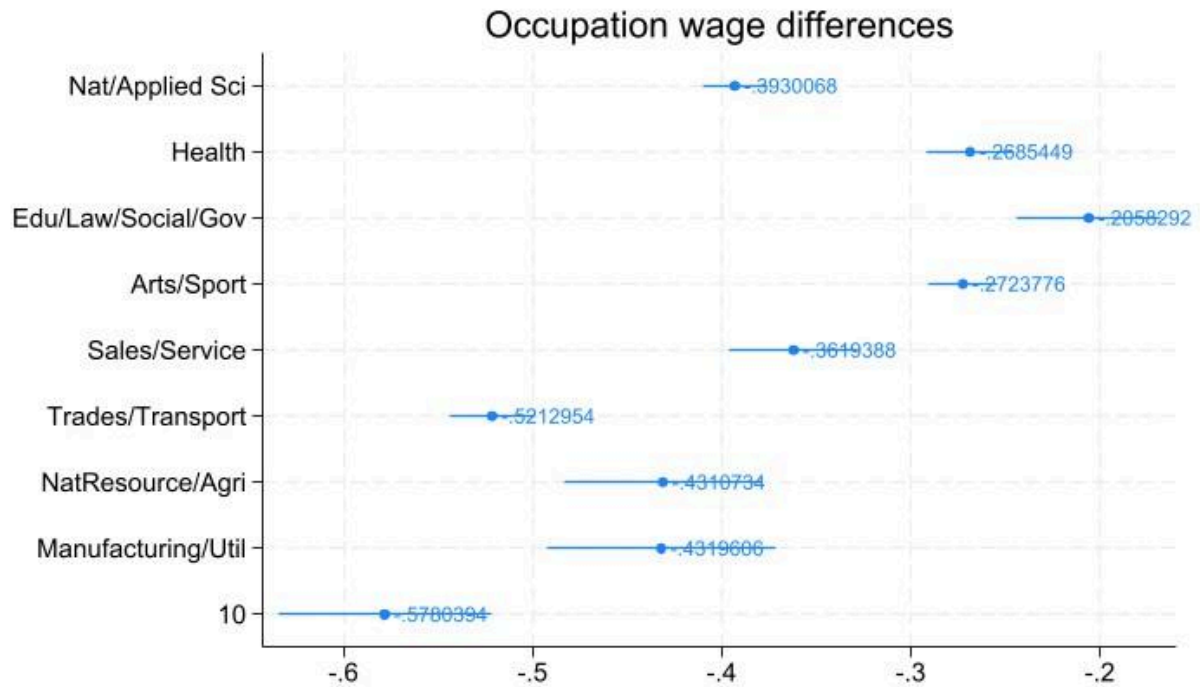


Figure 2 shows large negative wage penalties for non-management occupations. Sales and service, arts/sports, manufacturing, trades, and natural resources all exhibit large negative coefficients, in some cases exceeding -50% . These results imply that occupational sorting is a major determinant of wage inequality.

5.5 Industry Effects

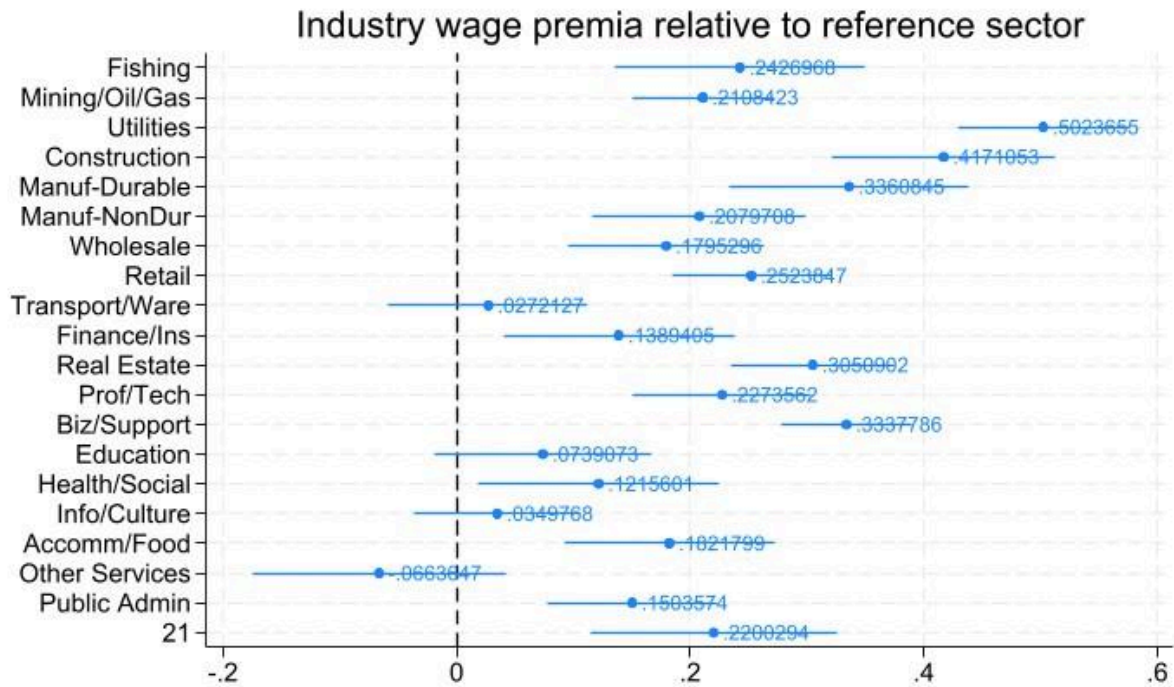


Figure 3 visualizes the industry coefficients. Wage premia are substantial in:

- Mining, oil, and gas (+50%)
- Utilities (+42%)
- Construction (+34%)
- Finance and insurance (+30%)
- Public administration (+22%)

Meanwhile, retail and accommodation/food services show little or no wage premium, reflecting their lower productivity structure.

6. Discussion

The results of this research confirm strongly documented trends in the Canadian labour market and also shed new light based on a comprehensive nationally representative data source. Firstly, a strong linear association between education and wages continues to be a fact. The regression analysis shows that with each additional level of schooling achieved, a dramatic percentage increase in hourly real wages occurs. This occurs even when controlling for gender, province of residence, occupation, industry, family composition, job characteristics, and local labor markets. Kernel density estimates demonstrate a dramatic gap in wage distributions for low-educated and high-educated individuals. This serves to underscore anew that better-educated individuals out earn their poorly educated counterparts not merely in terms of average wage levels but also in terms of systematic changes in wage distributions.

Secondly, based on this analysis, gender pay inequality remains a persistent phenomenon even when a wide range of covariates are considered. This means that a coefficient for women of -0.157 indicates that a 15% to 16% pay gap based on gender remains unattributed with regard to variations in terms of available covariates such as education, occupation, industry, and observed job characteristics. This corresponds with work done by Statistics Canada regarding the sources of pay inequity for women.

Thirdly, strong wage penalties and premiums with regard to occupation and industry emphasize the importance of sectorial sorting. The occupation graph highlights jobs where strong negative wage premiums exist compared with others, while professional jobs in technology and other STEM fields enjoy strong positive wage premiums. A similar graph for industry reveals strong positive wage premiums for jobs in the mining industry, public utilities, construction jobs, durable manufacturing jobs, finance jobs, and jobs in the professional services sector. This again indicates that while education counts for something, jobs and sectors matter a great deal.

Finally, provincial and CMA data indicate strong variations of wage levels when adjusted for factors associated with productivity. A strong positive wage premium exists for Alberta and British Columbia, while a strong negative premium exists for the Atlantic provinces. Such results underscore the significance of labour market conditions and industrial composition.

7. Policy Implications

The results have a number of key implications for Canadian labour market policy, education planning, and policies aimed at reducing income inequality.

1. Enhancing Access to Postsecondary Education

Owing to large gains in wages for those with more education—especially for a college diploma, a bachelor's degree, or a graduate degree—those policies that lower impediments to education would appear to be rewarded strongly. Such policies would include:

- increasing need-based grants;
- supporting first generation and low-income students
- enhanced rural reception with hybrid and satellite programming
- providing additional funding for college and apprenticeship programs.

The clear monotonic returns reported above argue for continued public investment in human capital formation.

2. Closing the Gender Wage Gap

The fact that a large gender coefficient still exists after adjustment for observable traits indicates that:

- more effective enforcement of pay transparency laws,
- wage audits within firms,
- extended childcare support to help women's labor force attachment.
- Targeted anti-discrimination and equity measures.

Closing gaps in unexplained wages has several implications for future poverty eradication and stability of household incomes.

3. Understanding the Role of Occupations & Industries

Owing to large variations in wage premia among sectors, policymakers may consider:

- increasing training opportunities connected with high return sectors (STEM, natural resources, construction, technical services),
- encouraging mobility and retraining for employees in sectors with declining or low wages, and

- Encourage sectors with persistent labor gaps to increase wages and investments in human capital.

Education does matter, but attainment of earnings outcomes is much influenced by occupational and industrial factors.

4. Regional Inequality

- Estimates for provinces and CMAs indicate a presence of disparities. Policy measures may include:
- supporting interprovincial mobility programs for labour.
- investing in areas with low wage premiums.
- expansion of infrastructure and diversification in Atlantic Canada, and
- analyzing provincial regulatory and taxation frameworks shaping labor demand and wage determination.

Large region-specific premiums represent a reflection of more profound underlying differences concerning productivity and equity.

5. Monitoring Post-COVID Labour Market Dynamics

The presence of year effects indicates a dramatic change in wages before and during the COVID-19 era. This points to a need for:

- ongoing monitoring of real wages in the post-pandemic period, - policies towards low-wage workers impacted by inflation, and - enhanced training programs for workers to keep pace with a continually changing labor market.

8. Conclusion

This research offers a thorough empirical examination of returns to education in Canada using data with more than 1.7 million observations obtained via the Labour Force Survey. The empirical evidence indicates a distinct and material wage premium with increasing levels of attainment consistent with human capital theory. Notably, the estimates are material even when adjusting for a broad array of demographic and economic characteristics. Graphic representations using kernel density estimates, predictions of log wages, and estimates of wage premiums for occupation and industry lend strong support to the prominent finding that education remains a foremost determinant of wages in Canada.

Nevertheless, the findings emphasize that factors beyond education matter. This is because occupation, industry, gender, and regional labor markets statistically affect wages significantly. This finding indicates that even with a more evenly distributed level of education among workers, gender and regional pay gaps would continue. Additionally, a major wage premium in particular sectors indicates that economic geography matters.

In sum, the results above argue for a diverse-oriented strategy for the labour market: supporting access to post-secondary education, simplifying conditions for access to very profitable sectors and jobs, enforcing pay equity, and geographically correcting imbalances. As the Canadian economy faces new changes because of technological progress, demographic trends, and the aftermath of the pandemic, research about the relationships concerning education and pay determination remains a critical source for propelling economic progress and social welfare.

9. References

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Appendix

Regression tables: (in order)

<pre> . reg ln_real_wage i.education experience i.GENDER i.marital_status i.province i.cma i.union_member i.occupation_major i.industry i.es > tablshment_size i.school_attendance i.economic_family_type i.age_group5 i.multiple_jobs i.class_of_worker i.age_youngest_child i.fi > rm_size i.year [aw=weight], vce(cluster province) (sum of wgt is 558,345,526) </pre>						
Linear regression	Number of obs	=	1,759,743			
	F(8, 9)	=	.			
	Prob > F	=	.			
	R-squared	=	0.4839			
	Root MSE	=	.33472			
(Std. err. adjusted for 10 clusters in province)						
ln_real_wage	Coefficient	Robust std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
education						
Some high school	.0378045	.0056738	6.66	0.000	.0249696	.0506394
High school graduate	.0674732	.007267	9.28	0.000	.051034	.0839124
Some postsecondary	.1014623	.0062064	16.35	0.000	.0874224	.1155021
Postsecondary certificate or diploma	.141502	.0039371	35.94	0.000	.1325957	.1504083
Bachelor's degree	.268298	.0124472	21.55	0.000	.2401405	.2964554
Above bachelor's degree	.3488428	.012765	27.33	0.000	.3199663	.3777194
experience	.0116842	.0007223	16.18	0.000	.0100502	.0133182
GENDER						
Woman	-.1574769	.0069545	-22.64	0.000	-.1732091	-.1417446
marital_status						
Living in common-law	.0239885	.0124079	1.93	0.085	-.0040802	.0520572
Widowed	.0280224	.0114601	2.45	0.037	.002098	.0539469
Separated	.0547442	.0063695	8.59	0.000	.0403354	.069153
Divorced	.0794273	.0082278	9.65	0.000	.0608147	.0980399
Single, never married	.0553107	.0130989	4.22	0.002	.025679	.0849424
province						
Prince Edward Island	-.0685573	.0020909	-32.79	0.000	-.0732872	-.0638274
Nova Scotia	-.0543787	.0019362	-28.08	0.000	-.0587588	-.0499986
New Brunswick	-.0620833	.0017258	-35.97	0.000	-.0659874	-.0581793
Quebec	.0133844	.0047263	2.83	0.020	.0026928	.0240761
Ontario	.0598328	.001335	44.82	0.000	.0568128	.0628528
Manitoba	-.0087892	.0018007	-4.88	0.001	-.0128627	-.0047156
Saskatchewan	.0469622	.0016062	29.24	0.000	.0433289	.0505956
Alberta	.1237208	.0029127	42.48	0.000	.1171318	.1303097
British Columbia	.1111233	.0017557	63.29	0.000	.1071516	.115095
cma						
Québec	.0168956	.0031931	5.29	0.000	.0096724	.0241189
Montréal	.0022425	.004453	0.50	0.627	-.0078308	.0123159
Ottawa-Gatineau (Ontario part)	.0454618	.0051209	8.88	0.000	.0338774	.0570461
Toronto	-.0041961	.0028544	-1.47	0.176	-.0106533	.0022611
Hamilton	.0365578	.0019496	18.75	0.000	.0321475	.0409681
Winnipeg	-.0312683	.003248	-9.63	0.000	-.0386156	-.0239209
Calgary	-.0062045	.0047648	-1.30	0.225	-.0169833	.0045743
Edmonton	-.0051135	.0042239	-1.21	0.257	-.0146686	.0044417
Vancouver	-.0246082	.0026208	-9.39	0.000	-.0305368	-.0186796
union_member						
Not a member but covered by a union contract	.0162832	.0103422	1.57	0.150	-.0071124	.0396788
Non-unionized	.0071049	.0041359	1.72	0.120	-.0022511	.0164609

occupation_major						
Business, finance and administration (non-management)	-.3930068	.0074312	-52.89	0.000	-.4098173	-.3761963
Natural and applied sciences (non-management)	-.2685448	.0101507	-26.46	0.000	-.2915073	-.2455824
Health occupations (non-management)	-.2058292	.0167199	-12.31	0.000	-.2436522	-.1680062
Education, law, social, community and government services (non-...)	-.2723776	.0079122	-34.42	0.000	-.2902763	-.254479
Art, culture, recreation and sport (non-management)	-.3619388	.0149934	-24.14	0.000	-.3958563	-.3280214
Sales and service (non-management)	-.5212955	.009921	-52.54	0.000	-.5437384	-.4988525
Trades, transport and equipment operators	-.4310734	.0232	-18.58	0.000	-.4835556	-.3785912
Natural resources, agriculture and related production	-.4319606	.0268876	-16.07	0.000	-.4927845	-.3711366
Manufacturing and utilities (non-management)	-.5780394	.0248953	-23.22	0.000	-.6343565	-.5217223
industry						
Forestry and logging	.2426968	.0472003	5.14	0.001	.1359223	.3494714
Fishing, hunting and trapping	.2108423	.026901	7.84	0.000	.149988	.2716966
Mining, quarrying, oil and gas	.5023655	.0325072	15.45	0.000	.4288292	.5759018
Utilities	.4171053	.0421814	9.89	0.000	.3216843	.5125262
Construction	.3360846	.0453719	7.41	0.000	.2334461	.438723
Manufacturing - durable goods	.2079708	.0402683	5.16	0.001	.1168777	.299064
Manufacturing - non-durable goods	.1795296	.0370603	4.84	0.001	.0956932	.2633659
Wholesale trade	.2523847	.0301096	8.38	0.000	.1842719	.3204974
Retail trade	.0272127	.0377368	0.72	0.489	-.0581538	.1125793
Transportation and warehousing	.1389405	.0435218	3.19	0.011	.0404873	.2373937
Finance and insurance	.3050902	.0308945	9.88	0.000	.2352021	.3749783
Real estate and rental/leasing	.2273562	.0338	6.73	0.000	.1508952	.3038172
Professional, scientific and technical services	.3337786	.0248463	13.43	0.000	.2775725	.3899848
Business, building and support services	.0739073	.0408182	1.81	0.104	-.0184299	.1662445
Educational services	.1215601	.0458819	2.65	0.027	.0177681	.2253521
Health care and social assistance	.0349768	.0315197	1.11	0.296	-.0363257	.1062794
Information, culture and recreation	.1821799	.039731	4.59	0.001	.092302	.2720578
Accommodation and food services	-.0663647	.0479035	-1.39	0.199	-.1747298	.0420005
Other services (except public admin)	.1503574	.032236	4.66	0.001	.0774345	.2232803
Public administration	.2200294	.0463592	4.75	0.001	.1151575	.3249012
establishment_size						
20-99 employees	.0298046	.0077499	3.85	0.004	.012273	.0473361
100-500 employees	.0704467	.0089721	7.85	0.000	.0501505	.0907429
More than 500 employees	.1278499	.0110578	11.56	0.000	.1028355	.1528644
school_attendance						
Full-time student	-.1592868	.0113954	-13.98	0.000	-.1850651	-.1335085
Part-time student	-.0237138	.0110345	-2.15	0.060	-.0486755	.0012479
economic_family_type						
Dual-earner couple, no children	-.0023822	.0156232	-0.15	0.882	-.0377243	.0329599
Dual-earner couple, child 0-17	.0127283	.0101847	1.25	0.243	-.0103111	.0357678
Dual-earner couple, child 18-24	.0006812	.0116166	0.06	0.955	-.0255974	.0269597
Single-earner couple, man employed, no children	.153315	.0073623	20.82	0.000	.1366604	.1699696
Single-earner couple, man employed, child 0-17	-.0072946	.0058564	-1.25	0.244	-.0205427	.0059534
Single-earner couple, man employed, child 18-24	.0427372	.0138655	3.08	0.013	.0113713	.074103
Single-earner couple, woman employed, no children	-.3563601	.0105868	-33.66	0.000	-.3803092	-.332411
Single-earner couple, woman employed, child 0-17	-.0162296	.0084632	-1.92	0.087	-.0353748	.0029155
Single-earner couple, woman employed, child 18-24	-.0064831	.0087646	-0.74	0.478	-.02631	.0133438
Lone-parent employed, child 0-17	-.0514446	.0146642	-3.51	0.007	-.0846173	-.0182719
Lone-parent employed, child 18-24	-.0567467	.0108623	-5.22	0.001	-.081319	-.0321744
Lone-parent not employed, child 0-17	.2667883	.0137316	19.43	0.000	.2357254	.2978513
age_group5						
20-24	-.0014147	.0150487	-0.09	0.927	-.0354573	.0326278
25-29	.0466941	.0076173	6.13	0.000	.0294625	.0639257
30-34	.0979278	.0091567	10.69	0.000	.0772138	.1186417
35-39	.1216983	.0121424	10.02	0.000	.0942303	.1491662
40-44	.1290397	.0168468	7.66	0.000	.0909296	.1671498

45-49	.1314231	.0192774	6.82	0.000	.0878146	.1750316
50-54	.1245298	.0220983	5.64	0.000	.07454	.1745196
55-59	.108688	.0224705	4.84	0.001	.0578562	.1595197
60-64	.0616961	.0220464	2.80	0.021	.0118238	.1115685
65-69	.0977373	.0859905	1.14	0.285	-.0967868	.2922614
70+	-.0804264	.0670294	-1.20	0.261	-.2320574	.0712045
multiple_jobs Multiple jobholder	-.0511782	.0069353	-7.38	0.000	-.066867	-.0354895
class_of_worker Private sector	-.0853955	.0173362	-4.93	0.001	-.1246128	-.0461782
age_youngest_child Child 6-12	-.0073293	.009845	-0.74	0.476	-.0296002	.0149416
Child 13-17	-.0079241	.0155977	-0.51	0.624	-.0432084	.0273602
Child 18-24	-.0074288	.0316152	-0.23	0.819	-.0789473	.0640897
firm_size 20-99 employees	.0534308	.0047406	11.27	0.000	.0427069	.0641547
100-500 employees	.0711612	.0047756	14.90	0.000	.060358	.0819644
More than 500 employees	.0939931	.0078901	11.91	0.000	.0761445	.1118416
year 2019	.0031294	.0026988	1.16	0.276	-.0029758	.0092346
2020	.0325246	.0043868	7.41	0.000	.022601	.0424481
2021	.0180084	.0083674	2.15	0.060	-.00092	.0369368
2022	-.0140243	.0125256	-1.12	0.292	-.0423591	.0143106
2023	-.0097573	.013903	-0.70	0.501	-.0412081	.0216934
2024	.0037385	.015424	0.24	0.814	-.031153	.0386301
2025	.0162947	.0164681	0.99	0.348	-.0209587	.0535482
_cons	7.921205	.0797093	99.38	0.000	7.74089	8.10152

Stata codes

Regression: `reg ln_real_wage i.education experience i.GENDER i.marital_status i.province i.cma i.union_member i.occupation_major i.industry i.establishment_size i.school_attendance i.economic_family_type i.age_group5 i.multiple_jobs i.class_of_worker i.age_youngest_child i.firm_size i.year [aw=weight], vce(cluster province)`

Figure 1: `twoway (kdensity ln_real_wage if education==0, lcolor(blue)) (kdensity ln_real_wage if education==5, lcolor(red)), legend(order(1 "0-8 years" 2 "BA")) title("Kernel density of log real wages: 0-8 years vs BA") xtitle("Log real hourly wage") ytitle("Density")`

Figure 2: `coefplot, keep(*occupation_major*) drop(_cons) xline(0) title("Occupation wage differences") ylabel(, labszsize(small))`

Figure 3: `coefplot, keep(*industry*) drop(_cons) xline(0) title("Industry wage premia relative to reference sector") ylabel(, labszsize(small))`